

Subject Code	AF6109
Subject Title	Qualitative and Quantitative Methods for Business Research
Credit Value	3
Level	6
Normal Duration	One Semester
Pre-requisite/ Co-requisite/ Exclusion	None
Objectives	This subject contributes to the achievement of the DMgt outcome by sharpening students' ability to conduct original applied research and ethical awareness in business administration, laying the foundation for lifelong learning within Hong Kong and global contexts (Outcome 3). The main purpose of this subject is to provide students with a fundamental philosophy and framework on both qualitative and quantitative approaches to research. It is expected that students would draw useful reference on the concepts, methodologies, practical applications and limitations throughout the course and understand how these methods can be used in artificial intelligence and entrepreneurship. Practical examples on research design will be elaborated and discussed so that students can enhance their understanding and ability in conducting a similar project on their own.
Intended Learning Outcomes	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: - understand key concepts underlying qualitative and quantitative approaches to research, including the collection and analysis of qualitative and quantitative data; - understand a range of different methods and techniques (such as linear regression models, some advanced econometric theories and models, etc.) used to conduct empirical business research; - understand the requirements and standards of academic research, including the ability to undertake critical reading and evaluation of published scholarly work; - understand qualitative and quantitative designs in relation to specific business topics such as artificial intelligence and entrepreneurship.
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus	- Fundamental concepts in qualitative and quantitative research: problem definition, hypothesis development, research design, data collection & analysis; - Principle and methods of research design and how to formulate research designs appropriate to a variety of business topics; - Principle qualitative and quantitative methods used to conduct business research and how to apply those methods to real data; - Statistical and econometric techniques to analyze data, including: - Multiple linear regression models: least squares estimation, controls, fixed effects, dummy variables, heteroscedasticity. - Endogeneity problems: matching, instrumental variables, two stage least squares estimation. - Qualitative and limited dependent variable models: logit/probit models, self-selection models, Tobit model. - Panel data models: fixed vs random effects models. - Some advanced econometric models: difference-in-differences (DiD), regression discontinuity.
Teaching/Learning Methodology	The teaching format of the subject will be based on various workshops. An interactive learning approach will be used throughout the seminars where students are exposed to enquiry methods and activities to encourage and develop applications, problem solving and critical thinking skills. Active participation in this subject is required.

Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes	Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)			
			a.	b.	c.	d.
	Continuous Assessment*	100%				
	1. Group project / presentation	40%	✓	✓	✓	✓
	2. Individual report / assignment	40%	✓	✓	✓	✓
	3. Class participation	20%	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Total	100 %				
<i>*Weighting of assessment methods/tasks in continuous assessment may be different, subject to each subject lecturer.</i>						
Explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes:						
Group project is intended to provide students with an opportunity to read and understand scholarly journal articles that utilize qualitative and quantitative research methods and to accurately assess their contributions, strength, and weaknesses.						
Individual research report is designed to train student to learn how to conduct practical research work on their own. Each student will take initiative to discuss research ideas with classmates and lecturers, and decide on the design of a specific research topics suitable for further exploration. Each student is required to write a report on his/her research plan. By such assessment, it is expected that their understanding on the concepts of qualitative approaches to research will be enhanced.						
Individual reflection is designed to assess students’ understanding about how qualitative and quantitative methods can be used to understand specific business topics such as artificial intelligence and entrepreneurship.						
Class participation and interaction is a necessary means of assessment at such a high level workshop as it will provide good feedback to each individual classmate on their research ideas. The experience sharing session in the workshop will be assessed by class participation. It will help clarify the concepts, methodology and critical success factors in performing research project.						
Feedback is given to students immediately following the presentations and all students are invited to join this discussion.						
Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:					
	▪ Lectures		30 Hrs.			
	Other student study effort:					
	▪ Preparation for lectures		30 Hrs.			
	▪ Preparation for assignment / group project and presentation		60 Hrs.			
	▪ Total student study effort		120 Hrs.			

**Reading List and
References**

Field, A. 2013. *Discovering Statistics Using IBM SPSS Statistics*. London: Sage.

Gephhardt, R. P. 2004. Qualitative Research and the Academy of Management Journal. *Academy of Management Journal*, 47: 454-462.

Van de Ven, A. H. 2007. *Engaged scholarship: A guide for organizational and social research*. New York: Oxford University Press.

Shadish, W. R., Cook, T. D., & Campbell, D. T. 2002. *Experimental and Quasi-experimental Designs for Generalized Causal Inference*. Boston, MA: Houghton Mifflin.

Scott, W. R. 2019 *Financial Accounting Theory*, 8th Edition, Pearson.

Wooldridge, J. M. 2020 *Introductory Econometrics: A Modern Approach*, 7th Edition, Cengage.

Brattström, A. & Faems, D. 2020, Inter-Organizational Relationships as Political Battlefields: How Fragmentation within Organizations Shapes Relational Dynamics between Organizations, *Academy of Management Journal*, 63: 1591-1620.

Hengst, I-A., Jarzabkowski, P., Hoegl, M., & Muethel, M. 2020, Toward a Process Theory of Making Sustainability Strategies Legitimate in Action, *Academy of Management Journal*, 63: 246-271.

Snihur, Y. & Zott, C. 2020, The Genesis and Metamorphosis of Novelty Imprints: How Business Model Innovation Emerges in Young Ventures, *Academy of Management Journal*, 63: 554-583.

Topic-specific academic journal articles assigned by the lecturers